

4. Project Planning Phase

4.1 Purpose of this phase

Planning turns the design into an executable schedule. It defines the work to be done, who does it, when, with what resources, and how risks and progress will be managed. A good plan keeps the project realistic and visible.

4.2 Project objectives

1. Deliver a working Standard Laptop Request catalog item with an automated Flow Designer flow.
2. Eliminate manual email-based approvals and manual creation of procurement tasks.
3. Provide notifications and status visibility for requesters.
4. Complete testing, documentation and a demonstration within the project timeline.

4.3 Approach and methodology

The project follows a lightweight **iterative (agile-style) approach**. The work is split into short sprints, each ending with a working increment that can be demonstrated and corrected. This suits low-code development, where a flow can be built, run and adjusted quickly.

4.4 Work breakdown structure

No.	Work package	Key tasks
1	Setup	Prepare instance, roles, groups, sample users and managers
2	Catalog	Create catalog item, variables, client script, categories
3	Flow	Build main flow, approval logic, task creation, updates
4	Subflows	Build reusable approval and task subflows
5	Notifications	Create and link email notifications
6	Reporting	Build reports and dashboard
7	Testing	Prepare and run test cases, fix defects
8	Documentation	User guide, admin guide, design document
9	Demonstration	Prepare data, script and walkthrough

4.5 Timeline (sample 4-week plan)

Week	Focus	Deliverable
Week 1	Setup, catalog item, variables, client script	Working request form
Week 2	Main flow, approval, procurement and IT tasks	End-to-end happy path
Week 3	Rejection handling, reminders, notifications, reports, testing	Tested solution
Week 4	Defect fixing, documentation, demonstration rehearsal	Final package and demo

4.6 Milestones

Milestone	Description
M1	Environment ready and catalog item published
M2	Flow runs successfully on the approval path
M3	Rejection, reminder and error handling completed
M4	Testing complete with critical defects resolved
M5	Documentation complete
M6	Final demonstration

4.7 Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Project lead	Coordination, schedule, status tracking
ServiceNow developer	Catalog item, flow, subflows, notifications
Business analyst	Requirements, acceptance criteria, user guide
Tester	Test cases, execution, defect logging
Process owner / reviewer	Validates approval rules and outcomes

For a small team or individual project, several roles may be held by the same person, but the responsibilities remain distinct.

4.8 Resource plan

- **Platform:** ServiceNow developer instance with Flow Designer, Service Catalog and Notifications.
- **Test data:** sample users with managers, a requester, an approver, a fallback approver, procurement and IT group members.
- **Tools:** browser, email or notification preview, update set for moving changes between instances.
- **Documentation:** word processor and screenshot tool.

4.9 Risk management plan

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Manager missing on user record	Medium	High	Fallback approver logic; data check before testing
Notifications not delivered	Medium	Medium	Verify email configuration; review email logs
Scope creep (custom laptops, vendor integration)	High	Medium	Strict scope statement; log as future enhancements
Approvers ignore requests	Medium	High	Reminders and escalation
Flow errors in edge cases	Medium	Medium	Error handling and thorough testing
Limited time	Medium	High	Prioritise high-priority requirements first

4.10 Communication plan

- Short progress update at the end of each week.
- Sprint review demonstrating the increment.
- Immediate reporting of blockers to the project lead.

- Shared repository for documents and screenshots.

4.11 Quality plan

- Naming conventions: descriptive names for flows, actions, variables and notifications.
- Peer review of the flow before testing.
- Requirement-to-test traceability.
- Definition of Done: built, tested, documented and reviewed.

4.12 Change management

Any change to scope is logged, assessed for effort and impact, and approved by the project lead and process owner before being added. Changes to the configuration are captured in an **update set** so they can be tracked and moved to other instances.

4.13 Deployment plan (overview)

1. Develop and test in the development instance.
2. Capture all configuration in an update set.
3. Move to a test/UAT instance for user acceptance.
4. After approval, promote to production and monitor initial executions.

4.14 Success measures

Measure	Target
Requests submitted through catalog	100% of standard laptop requests
Manual steps between submission and procurement task	Zero
Time to create procurement task after approval	Immediate
Requester notifications sent at all milestones	100%
Critical defects at demonstration	Zero

4.15 Outcome of the phase

An agreed plan comprising scope, work packages, timeline, roles, resources, risks, communication, quality and deployment approaches. The team is now ready to build.